

GETTING STARTED

Overview

Claude Code is an agentic coding tool that reads your codebase, edits files, runs commands, and integrates with your development tools. Available in your terminal, IDE, desktop app, and browser.

Claude Code is an AI-powered coding assistant that helps you build features, fix bugs, and automate development tasks. It understands your entire codebase and can work across multiple files and tools to get things done.

Get started

Choose your environment to get started. Most surfaces require a [Claude subscription](#) or [Anthropic Console](#) account. The Terminal CLI and VS Code also support [third-party providers](#).

Terminal

The full-featured CLI for working with Claude Code directly in your terminal. Edit files, run commands, and manage your entire project from the command line. To install Claude Code, use one of the following methods:

Native Install (Recommended) **Homebrew** **WinGet**

macOS, Linux, WSL:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Windows PowerShell:

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

Windows CMD:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.cmd -o install.cmd &&  
install.cmd && del install.cmd
```

If you see `The token '&&' is not a valid statement separator`, you're in PowerShell, not CMD. If you see `'irm' is not recognized as an internal or external command`, you're in CMD, not PowerShell. Your prompt shows `PS C:\` when you're in PowerShell and `C:\` without the `PS` when you're in CMD.

If the install command fails with `syntax error near unexpected token '<'`, a `403`, or another curl error, see [Troubleshoot installation](#) to match the error to a fix and for alternative install methods.

Git for Windows is recommended on native Windows so Claude Code can use the Bash tool. If Git for Windows is not installed, Claude Code uses PowerShell as the shell tool instead. WSL setups do not need Git for Windows.

❶ Native installations automatically update in the background to keep you on the latest version.

```
brew install --cask claude-code
```

Homebrew offers two casks. `claude-code` tracks the stable release channel, which is typically about a week behind and skips releases with major regressions. `claude-code@latest` tracks the latest channel and receives new versions as soon as they ship.

❶ Homebrew installations do not auto-update. Run `brew upgrade claude-code` or `brew upgrade claude-code@latest`, depending on which cask you installed, to get the latest features and security fixes.

```
winget install Anthropic.ClaudeCode
```

❶ WinGet installations do not auto-update. Run `winget upgrade Anthropic.ClaudeCode` periodically to get the latest features and security fixes.

You can also install with **apt, dnf, or apk** on Debian, Fedora, RHEL, and Alpine. Then start Claude Code in any project:

```
cd your-project  
claude
```

You'll be prompted to log in on first use. That's it! [Continue with the Quickstart →](#)

💡 See [advanced setup](#) for installation options, manual updates, or uninstallation instructions. Visit [installation troubleshooting](#) if you hit issues.

VS Code

macOS, Linux, WSL:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

Windows PowerShell:

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

Windows CMD:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.cmd -o install.cmd &&  
install.cmd && del install.cmd
```

If you see `The token '&&' is not a valid statement separator`, you're in PowerShell, not CMD. If you see `'irm' is not recognized as an internal or external command`, you're in CMD, not PowerShell. Your prompt shows `PS C:\` when you're in PowerShell and `C:\` without the `PS` when you're in CMD. If the install command fails with `syntax error near unexpected token '<'`, a `403`, or another curl error, see [Troubleshoot installation](#) to match the error to a fix and for alternative install methods. [Git for Windows](#) is recommended on native Windows so Claude Code can use the Bash tool. If Git for Windows is not installed, Claude Code uses PowerShell as the shell tool instead. WSL setups do not need Git for Windows.

- ⓘ Native installations automatically update in the background to keep you on the latest version.

Desktop app

```
brew install --cask claude-code
```

Homebrew offers two casks. `claude-code` tracks the stable release channel, which is typically about a week behind and skips releases with major regressions. `claude-code@latest` tracks the latest channel and receives new versions as soon as they ship.

- ⓘ Homebrew installations do not auto-update. Run `brew upgrade claude-code` or `brew upgrade claude-code@latest`, depending on which cask you installed, to get the latest features and security fixes.

Web

```
winget install Anthropic.ClaudeCode
```

- ⓘ WinGet installations do not auto-update. Run `winget upgrade Anthropic.ClaudeCode` periodically to get the latest features and security fixes.

JetBrains

The VS Code extension provides inline diffs, @-mentions, plan review, and conversation history directly in your editor.

- [Install for VS Code](#)
- [Install for Cursor](#)

Or search for “Claude Code” in the Extensions view (`Cmd+Shift+X` on Mac, `Ctrl+Shift+X` on

Windows/Linux). After installing, open the Command Palette (`Cmd+Shift+P` / `Ctrl+Shift+P`), type “Claude Code”, and select **Open in New Tab**. [Get started with VS Code →](#)

Native Install (Recommended)

A standalone app for running Claude Code outside your IDE or terminal. Review diffs visually, run multiple sessions side by side, schedule recurring tasks, and kick off cloud sessions. Download and install:

- [macOS](#) (Intel and Apple Silicon)
- [Windows](#) (x64)
- [Windows ARM64](#)

After installing, launch Claude, sign in, and click the **Code** tab to start coding. A [paid subscription](#) is required. [Learn more about the desktop app →](#)

Homebrew

Run Claude Code in your browser with no local setup. Kick off long-running tasks and check back when they’re done, work on repos you don’t have locally, or run multiple tasks in parallel. Available on desktop browsers and the Claude iOS app. Start coding at [claude.ai/code](#). [Get started on the web →](#)

WinGet

A plugin for IntelliJ IDEA, PyCharm, WebStorm, and other JetBrains IDEs with interactive diff viewing and selection context sharing. Install the [Claude Code plugin](#) from the JetBrains Marketplace and restart your IDE. The plugin requires the Claude Code CLI, installed separately; see the [JetBrains setup steps](#). [Get started with JetBrains →](#)

What you can do

Here are some of the ways you can use Claude Code:

-  Automate the work you keep putting off

- ▶  Build features and fix bugs
- ▶  Create commits and pull requests
- ▶  Connect your tools with MCP
- ▶  Customize with instructions, skills, and hooks
- ▶  Run agent teams and build custom agents
- ▶  Pipe, script, and automate with the CLI
- ▶  Schedule recurring tasks
- ▶  Work from anywhere

Use Claude Code everywhere

Each surface connects to the same underlying Claude Code engine, so your CLAUDE.md files, settings, and MCP servers work across all of them.

Beyond the Terminal, VS Code, JetBrains, Desktop, and Web environments above, Claude Code integrates with CI/CD, chat, and browser workflows:

I want to...	Best option
Continue a local session from my phone or another device	<u>Remote Control</u>
Push events from Telegram, Discord, iMessage, or my own webhooks into a session	<u>Channels</u>
Start a task locally, continue on mobile	<u>Web</u> or <u>Claude iOS app</u>
Run Claude on a recurring schedule	<u>Routines</u> or <u>Desktop scheduled tasks</u>
Automate PR reviews and issue triage	<u>GitHub Actions</u> or <u>GitLab CI/CD</u>
Get automatic code review on every PR	<u>GitHub Code Review</u>
Route bug reports from Slack to pull requests	<u>Slack</u>

I want to...	Best option
Debug live web applications	<u>Chrome</u>
Build custom agents for your own workflows	<u>Agent SDK</u>

Next steps

Once you’ve installed Claude Code, these guides help you go deeper.

- **Quickstart**: walk through your first real task, from exploring a codebase to committing a fix
- **Store instructions and memories**: give Claude persistent instructions with CLAUDE.md files and auto memory
- **Common workflows** and **best practices**: patterns for getting the most out of Claude Code
- **Settings**: customize Claude Code for your workflow
- **Troubleshooting**: solutions for common issues
- **code.claude.com**: demos, pricing, and product details